

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.6: Adjectives and Agreement

Decline common adjective systems and trace agreement chains across attributive, predicate, and substantial uses

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.5 mastery: discriminate noun forms across all five declensions
Next	EL-I.7, <i>Sum</i> and <i>Possum</i>

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 6: Adjectives and Agreement

On completing this unit, you can:

- decline first/second-declension and third-declension adjectives;
- make an adjective agree with its noun in gender, number, and case;
- distinguish attributive, predicate, and substantival uses; and
- explain adjective forms in familiar Mass texts.

1.1 First/second-declension adjectives

The dictionary entry *sanctus*, -a, -um supplies masculine, feminine, and neuter nominative singular. Its masculine and neuter endings follow the second declension; its feminine endings follow the first.

An adjective may be **attributive**, forming part of a noun phrase (*vitam æternam*, “eternal life”); **predicate**, completing a linking verb (*dignum est*, “it is fitting”); or **substantival**, standing in place of an understood noun (*sancti*, “the holy ones”). These are uses in a sentence, not separate adjective forms.

	Singular			Plural		
	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.
Nom.	sanctus	sancta	sanctum	sancti	sanctæ	sancta
Gen.	sancti	sanctæ	sancti	sanctorum	sanctarum	sanctorum
Dat.	sancto	sanctæ	sancto	sanctis	sanctis	sanctis
Acc.	sanctum	sanctam	sanctum	sanctos	sanctas	sancta
Abl.	sancto	sancta	sancto	sanctis	sanctis	sanctis
Voc.	sancte	sancta	sanctum	sancti	sanctæ	sancta

1.2 Third-declension adjectives

A two-termination adjective such as *omnis*, *omne* has one nominative singular for masculine and feminine and another for neuter. Its genitive *omnis* reveals the stem. These adjectives normally use i-stem endings.

	Singular		Plural	
	m./f.	n.	m./f.	n.
Nom.	omnis	omne	omnes	omnia
Gen.	omnis	omnis	omnium	omnium
Dat.	omni	omni	omnibus	omnibus
Acc.	omnem	omne	omnes	omnia
Abl.	omni	omni	omnibus	omnibus
Voc.	omnis	omne	omnes	omnia

A one-termination adjective lists nominative and genitive, for example *felix*, *felicis*, “happy”. Its nominative singular *felix* serves all three genders; other forms are built on *felic-*: accusative masculine/feminine *felicem*, neuter *felix*, ablative *felici*, plural masculine/feminine *felices*, neuter *felia*, and genitive plural *felicium*. Gender belongs to the noun, not to the adjective’s declension.

Agreement is a matching rule

An adjective must match its noun in gender, number, and case, but its ending need not look like the noun's ending. In *Patris omnipotentis*, both words are masculine singular genitive; in *gloria magna*, both are feminine singular nominative. Determine the noun first, then choose the adjective coordinates.

Worked example: *Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus Dominus Deus Sabaoth*

Worked passage ID: W.I.20; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Each *Sanctus* is masculine singular nominative and agrees with *Dominus*; *Deus* stands in **apposition**, meaning that it is a second noun in the same case that identifies the same referent. Translation: “Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts.”

Worked example: *Pleni sunt cæli et terra gloria tua*

Worked passage ID: W.I.21; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

cæli and *terra* form a compound subject. Predicate *pleni* is nominative plural masculine, the conventional form for a mixed-gender group. *gloria tua* is ablative after *pleni*: “Heaven and earth are full of your glory.”

Worked example: *Requiem æternam dona eis, Domine, et lux perpetua luceat eis*

Worked passage ID: W.I.22; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

æternam is feminine singular accusative with object *requiem*; *perpetua* is feminine singular nominative with subject *lux*. Translation: “Grant them eternal rest, O Lord, and may perpetual light shine upon them.”

Worked example: *Omnipotens sempiterne Deus*

Worked passage ID: W.I.23; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Deus is being addressed. One-termination *omnipotens* has a vocative identical to its nominative; *sempiterne* is the masculine singular vocative of *sempiternus*. Translation: “Almighty, eternal God.”

Worked example: *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam in vitam æternam*

Worked passage ID: W.I.24; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

nostri agrees with genitive *Domini*; *meam* agrees with accusative *animam*; *æternam* agrees with accusative *vitam*. Translation: “May the Body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve my soul unto everlasting life.”

The three adjective uses recur throughout the Missal: attributive adjectives belong inside noun phrases, predicate adjectives complete linking verbs, and substantival adjectives stand for contextually understood nouns.

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Copy both full paradigms and the listed forms of *felix*. Draw arrows between ten adjectives and the nouns they modify in the examples, writing gender-number-case over each arrow. Then inflect *sanctus* with *spiritus*, *ecclesia*, and *nomen* in nominative and accusative, singular and plural. Compose “eternal light”, *lux æterna*; “of the almighty Father”, *Patris omnipotentis*; and “all holy names”, *omnia nomina sancta*.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 First/second-declension adjectives — transfer practice

Connection. An agreement-chain diagram separates the controller noun from every adjective coordinate it determines.

Transfer task. For three lesson noun phrases of different genders, place the noun in a center box and draw separate gender, number, and case arrows to its adjective. Transform each phrase to plural and update only the coordinates that change.

Retrieval check. Explain why a feminine noun does not require the noun and adjective to belong to the same declension.

1.2 Third-declension adjectives — transfer practice

Connection. Dictionary terminations tell how many nominative forms are displayed, not how many genders the adjective can modify.

Transfer task. Turn the lesson's two-termination and one-termination adjective entries into mini-paradigm cards. On each, mark the genitive stem and the neuter nominative/accusative forms.

Retrieval check. State the difference between a one-termination dictionary entry and an indeclinable word.

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. The three adjective uses can share identical morphology, so clause structure must determine the label.

Transfer task. For the lesson's attributive, predicate, and substantival examples, draw the controller chain where one is expressed and write the evidence that assigns each use. Then complete one lesson transformation across unlike declensions.

Retrieval check. Define the three uses without using only their English translations.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 6: Adjectives and Agreement

Worksheet I.21 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.21

Focus: First/second and third-declension adjective systems

Use: Always state the noun that controls agreement.

1. Give all three genders of *sanctus* in nominative singular, accusative singular, and nominative plural.

2. Give masculine/feminine and neuter forms of *omnis*, *omne* in accusative singular, nominative plural, and genitive plural.

3. Make *æternus*, *-a*, *-um* agree with *requiem*, *vita*, *lumen*, and *sæcula* in the cases shown by those isolated forms. List ambiguity where it remains.

4. Parse *Patris omnipotentis*: explain why the endings differ but agreement is exact.

5. Correct *lux perpetuum* and *omnia homines*; state each controlling noun's gender.

6. **Text:** *Requiem æternam dona eis, Domine, et lux perpetua luceat eis.*
Passage ID: I.21.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse both adjective-noun pairs, identify the vocative, and translate.

Worksheet I.24 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.24**Focus:** Adjective paradigms, agreement chains, and correction**Use:** Produce a complete rationale for every changed ending.

1. Write the full singular masculine paradigm of *sanctus* and the full singular feminine paradigm.

2. Write the plural paradigm of *omnis*, *omne*, giving masculine/feminine then neuter in every case.

3. Parse every adjective in *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam in vitam æternam*.

4. Transform *lux perpetua* to genitive plural, *spiritus sanctus* to accusative plural, and *omne genu* to nominative plural.

5. Diagnose *animas felicis custodit Deus bonus*.

6. **Text:** *Omnipotens sempiterne Deus, miserere nobis*.

Passage ID: I.24.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Treat this as a course-composed syntax example unless the unresolved continuous witness in the passage inventory is supplied; parse both adjectives and translate.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Produce the displayed adjective paradigms without an agreement-rule error, supply at least 27 of 30 requested forms, and analyze every adjective in four unseen sentences with at least 90 percent accuracy.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.7, *Sum* and *Possum*.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.22 and I.23 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

First/second-declension adjectives — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Every arrow must carry matching gender, number, and case before and after transformation. A correct explanation says that agreement coordinates are grammatical features; noun and adjective retain their own inflectional systems.

Third-declension adjectives — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each card must show a declining genitive and the relevant neuter forms. A one-termination adjective has one nominative form shared across genders but still declines; an indeclinable word would not change for case, number, or gender.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Attributive adjectives modify an expressed noun inside its phrase; predicate adjectives complete a linking assertion about a subject; substantival adjectives stand in the noun slot without an expressed head noun. The transformation must preserve the controller's gender, number, and case across all agreeing words.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 6: Adjectives and Agreement

Solution I.21 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.21

Focus: First/second and third-declension adjective systems

Use: Always state the noun that controls agreement.

1. Give all three genders of *sanctus* in nominative singular, accusative singular, and nominative plural.
Answer / model: Nominative singular: *sanctus, sancta, sanctum*; accusative singular: *sanctum, sanctam, sanctum*; nominative plural: *sancti, sanctæ, sancta*.
2. Give masculine/feminine and neuter forms of *omnis, omne* in accusative singular, nominative plural, and genitive plural.
Answer / model: Accusative singular: *omnem/omne*; nominative plural: *omnes/omnia*; genitive plural: *omnium* for all genders.
3. Make *æternus, -a, -um* agree with *requiem, vita, lumen, and sæcula* in the cases shown by those isolated forms. List ambiguity where it remains.
Answer / model: *requiem æternam*, accusative singular; *vita æterna*, nominative or ablative singular; *lumen æternum*, nominative or accusative singular; *sæcula æterna*, nominative or accusative plural.
4. Parse *Patris omnipotentis*: explain why the endings differ but agreement is exact.
Answer / model: Both are masculine singular genitive. *Patris* is a third-declension noun and *omnipotentis* a third-declension adjective; agreement matches coordinates, not letters alone.
5. Correct *lux perpetuum* and *omnia homines*; state each controlling noun's gender.
Answer / model: *lux perpetua*, because *lux* is feminine; *omnes homines*, because *homines* is masculine plural nominative or accusative.
6. **Text:** *Requiem æternam dona eis, Domine, et lux perpetua luceat eis.*
Passage ID: I.21.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Parse both adjective-noun pairs, identify the vocative, and translate.
Answer / notes: *requiem æternam*: feminine singular accusative object; *lux perpetua*: feminine singular nominative subject; *Domine*: masculine singular vocative. "Grant them eternal rest, O Lord, and may perpetual light shine upon them."

Solution I.24 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.24

Focus: Adjective paradigms, agreement chains, and correction

Use: Produce a complete rationale for every changed ending.

- Write the full singular masculine paradigm of *sanctus* and the full singular feminine paradigm.
Answer / model: Masculine: *sanctus, sancti, sancto, sanctum, sancto, sancte*. Feminine: *sancta, sanctæ, sanctæ, sanctam, sancta, sancta*.
- Write the plural paradigm of *omnis, omne*, giving masculine/feminine then neuter in every case.
Answer / model: Nom. *omnes/omnia*; gen. *omnium/omnium*; dat. *omnibus/omnibus*; acc. *omnes/omnia*; abl. *omnibus/omnibus*; voc. *omnes/omnia*.
- Parse every adjective in *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam in vitam æternam*.
Answer / model: *nostri*: masculine singular genitive with *Domini*; *meam*: feminine singular accusative with *animam*; *æternam*: feminine singular accusative with *vitam*.
- Transform *lux perpetua* to genitive plural, *spiritus sanctus* to accusative plural, and *omne genu* to nominative plural.
Answer / model: *lucum perpetuarum*; *spiritus sanctos*; *omnia genua*.
- Diagnose *animas felices custodit Deus bonus*.
Answer / model: *Animas felices custodit Deus bonus*. *felices* must be feminine plural accusative with *animas*; *bonus* correctly agrees with nominative singular *Deus*.
- Text:** *Omnipotens sempiterne Deus, miserere nobis*.
Passage ID: I.24.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Treat this as a course-composed syntax example unless the unresolved continuous witness in the passage inventory is supplied; parse both adjectives and translate.
Answer / notes: *Deus* is masculine singular direct address with nominative-shaped vocative. *omnipotens* is a one-termination third-declension adjective whose vocative equals nominative; *sempiterne* is first/second-declension masculine singular vocative. “Almighty, eternal God, have mercy on us.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.6, *Adjectives and Agreement*, in Triptych’s print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet covers ordinary adjective inflection and use; comparison belongs to Stage II.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf’s module map records this packet’s selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course’s controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See’s Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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